
Magistrate Wizard — Researching Case Law

Plain-language workflow. See the collected pack for the full set.

Magistrate Wizard

Architecture as implemented (migrations 0001–0067)

Court-anchored Docket · no admin bypass into private judicial content

13 August 2026

7. Researching case law

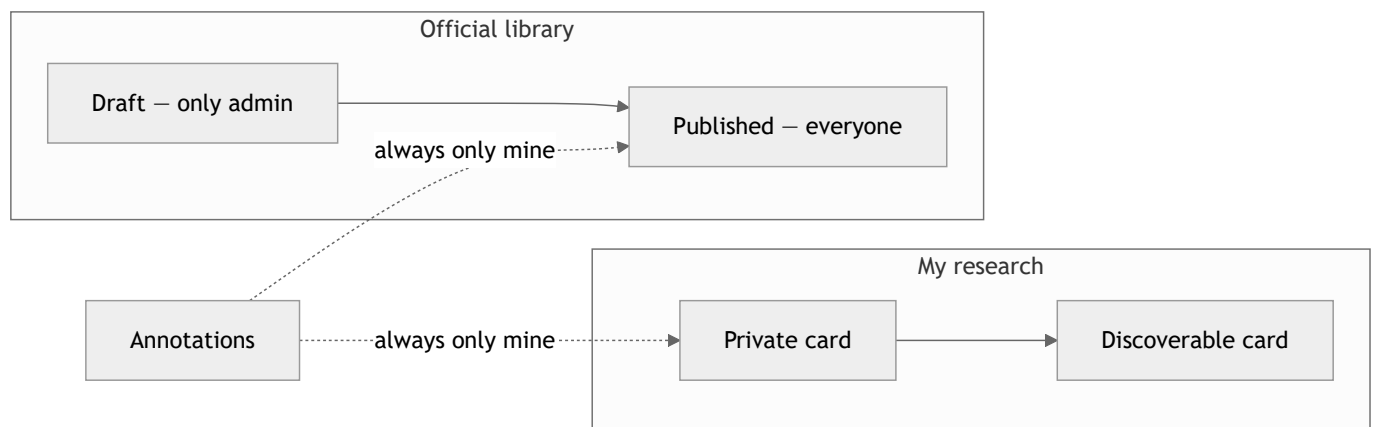
Who: every signed-in user for the published library; you for your private cards

Goal: find authorities, keep personal notes, pin them onto a matter

Two kinds of card, one list

Kind	Who writes it	Who reads it
Library (canonical)	Administrator, after review	Everyone, once published
Personal	You	You, unless you mark it discoverable

They live in the same **Case Law** area so a search can return both. They are not two different apps.



Browse published law

Open **Case Law**. Use the canonical tab. You may filter by jurisdiction and deciding court (the *reported* court — CCJ, a High Court, and so on — not the Magistrates' Court you sit).

Unpublished imports never appear here. That is how the library stays clean.

Your own cards

Create a personal entry for a decision you are studying. Citation need not be unique — two magistrates may both note the same case.

Mark discoverable only if you want colleagues to read the card. They still will not see your **annotations**.

Annotations

Pin a passage and a note. Multiple notes per case are fine. The person who owns the library entry (even an admin) cannot see *your* notes on it. If the parent card later becomes unreadable to you, your notes hide until you can read the parent again. They are not deleted.

Pin onto a docket matter

Open the Case Law card → **Link to a Docket Matter**. Pick a matter you sit or have retained. A share-only copy of a file is not enough to create the pin — the save will fail.

The matter's **Case Law** tab is a reverse view of pins already made. You do not create the link from there.

You do **not** need to “own” a library case to cite it — citing is what the library is for. Citing does not grant the next magistrate your private annotations.

What is not here yet

Sharing a personal card with one named colleague (the way docket shares work) is not built. Outlook does not ingest authorities. The library is not a web crawler — see the admin guide.